



I herniated my L4 and L5 discs on our honeymoon, and could not walk for eight days. It made me realize the value of having some emergency cash.

(Property of Kevin O'Leary)

Get Hitched and Stay Rich: 10 Ways to Minimize Wedding-Spending Madness

Okay, so you've hired me, Mr. Wonderful, the frugal wedding planner. Lucky for you—unlike those expensive busybodies running around with Bluetooth devices, I'm offering my wedding-planning services for free. My wedding-planner business is called Love Don't Cost a Dime, Inc. My goal: to force you to scrutinize every single cost, to reevaluate every expensive so-called tradition, and to find the cheapest possible way to get hitched and stay rich.

My approach is a little tongue-in-cheek, but the message is clear: Don't let matrimonial madness consume you.

1. **Forgo the engagement ring.** Diamond companies are almost as smart as banks—De Beers in particular. In the 1940s, it was the first company to market the idea that a guy has to spend a